

“The demand for open source professionals has definitely increased in the outsourced projects over the past few years”

India has enough of open source talent but, unfortunately, there are not many takers in the market. Enterprises still think twice before getting on to a Linux-based system, which is why India's open source talent is not getting as many opportunities, opines **Piyush Somani, MD/CEO, ESDS Software Solution Pvt Ltd.** **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** had an exclusive conversation with Somani about the difficulties those qualified in open source technologies face in the Indian market, and how his company is interested in promoting both the technology and the talent. Excerpts:



Piyush Somani, MD/CEO, ESDS Software Solution Pvt Ltd

Q You are present in other parts of the world apart from India. How much are you banking on the Indian market when it comes to selling technology products based on open source technology?

Our Indian business model is mainly focused on hosting and other services. These are related to hosting software-as-a-service, platforms-as-a-service, infrastructure-as-a-service, etc. We do the maximum number of hostings based on open source technology. I feel India is still not ready to accept open source technology the way the West has. While in the UK and US, most of our servers are based on Linux, in India, the number of Windows and Linux servers is almost the same.

Q Do you try to promote open source technology when you offer solutions to clients who are not particularly concerned whether the technology is open source or proprietary?

Yes, we offer our clients open source-based solutions first. Only in the cases where clients want Windows-based solutions, do we implement them. Else, we prefer offering open source solutions—only because of the kind of value they come with.

Q Do FOSS platforms or tools add value to the project's development?

Of course, they do. There are many add-ons that one can make with open source tools at their disposal. In Windows, it becomes very difficult to find a solution. I have been a systems administrator in the past. I always had trouble in understanding Windows and finding out the solutions to problems. There are so many bugs and one always has virus-related issues with the Windows platform. You have limitations on Windows and you cannot work out solutions for that platform easily. But with open source platforms, one has thousands of solutions at your disposal. In the open source domain, one just needs to do a Google search to find a solution to a problem. Open source technology allows users to be flexible and enjoy the luxury of inventing. This, in a way, helps in promoting open source technology. Because of contributions from the community, open source technology is more robust and popular. Developers from across the globe are contributing to a project, which strengthens the projects and helps in bringing out some really good piece of code. The only pre-requisite is that those in the community should have proper communication